

a semiconductor fab gets operational in the country along with these, that would be the icing on the cake.

“The time right now is presenting the biggest opportunity to anyone and everyone associated with electronics in India. IP creation, IC creation, and ATMP facilities are the three biggest opportunities where we can really start running. We have the talent, we have the opportunity, and it’s time we developed an ecosystem and created history in India,” explains Gupta.

What can work for start-ups?

An electronics start-up looking to start working on an idea would, on an average, require 1.5 to 2.0 million rupees for purchasing equipment required to start operations. This includes instruments that would be used to test prototypes. Most of the time such investments prove to be big hurdles for electronics start-ups.

“This is where good incubation centres can help electronics start-ups. Good incubation centres have integrated lab facilities that are equipped with most of such equipment and instruments that an electronics start-up needs. Electronics start-ups should be proactive in reaching out to such incubation centres,” advises Sanjeev Chopra, CEO, Electropreneur Park.

Good incubation facilities for start-ups can also help them source components by helping them meet with the right set of people in the supply chain. The value of the right set of components, as per Chopra, is usually realised after start-ups make mistakes in the initial phases of product development and choose components without any consultation with experts.

“A good incubation centre will help you get consultations from experts who have been there and done that before. The right consultation will make their game and the wrong one will break the same,” says Chopra.

He adds, “What if the components you used were at the end of their life cycle? You will simply have to redesign a lot of things once again. As someone looking to create history, this is something start-ups should be looking to avoid.”

A lot of individuals looking to start working on an idea usually do

Speakers



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founder and CEO,
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Nitin Kunkolienker, president
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Sanjeev Chopra, CEO,
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not know about the funds that big corporations park for helping start-ups under programs like CSR. A good incubation centre can help start-ups get access to these funds as well (provided the idea is good). These funds, at the very least, can be used to cover expenses during the prototyping stages. Additionally, the mentors that come attached with such funds are often the kind of experts every start-up dreams of getting mentored from.

“Ideas around electronics start-ups usually fail when the founders are not able to demonstrate the effectiveness of what they intend to achieve. A lot of start-ups, we have realised, have brilliant ideas but they do not pay attention to effectively demonstrating what they intend to do,” explains Chopra.

He adds, “The chances of your start-up getting funded increase if your demonstrations are on the point!”

“The kind of innovation that the Indian start-ups are struck with, unfortunately, is business models. There’s less focus on the technology and more focus on being successful in the short run, sell away the idea and move to another one,” feels Kishor N. Narag, founder and CEO, Narnix Technologies.

He says, “Their only challenge is to find out ways to monetise quickly! Electronics start-ups should always think of remaining in the game for at least five years. If software and services start-ups take three to five years to become Unicorns, electronics start-ups might take one or two more!”

The government of the country has always been under criticism for not offering enough help to the electronics industry. The same government has now announced schemes that are promising tens of billions of rupees as incentives for manufacturing electronics locally in the country. The big and small companies, as they start operations in the country, will need a lot of support from the local companies, and these support-providing companies will have a lot of opportunities to establish themselves as big names in the world of start-ups.

“The global business models are going to witness a sea of changes in the coming times. All nations are delving into their exit strategy from China. As they say, crisis often begets opportunity. This corona crisis is leading to a lot of opportunities. The only question is: Is India ready to grab these opportunities?” says Narag. **EFY**